FIRST-PERSON EXPLORATION / KNOWLEDGE-DRIVEN PUZZLES

OBLIVION

A world held in attention.

Sustained gaze gathers a fading world into temporary form. Turn away, and its particles disperse. Recurring eclipses erase what has not been preserved.

A CREATIVE TURN

From fear to attention

The horror concept used thrown stones to reveal unseen surroundings. Its partial particle world became a slower game about attention, memory and temporary encounters.

THE PLAYER'S PROGRESS

Knowledge changes the route

Players discover that the body follows the same rules as the world. A mirror, a staircase and a bridge acquire different possibilities when understood again.

SOLO DESIGN & DEVELOPMENT

Game design · Programming · Particle rendering · Modeling · Level design

Unity 2022.3 LTS / URP · Game Jam origin · About two weeks initially, followed by continued iteration · Complete playable main progression.

Cover supplied by the author / early concept conversations with a fellow student informed the idea; game production was completed independently.

What is worth holding on to?

Attention gives form. Self-recognition changes passage. Loss gives a decision its limit.

“An encounter can be worthwhile without lasting forever.”

A moment need not justify itself by what follows.

A SHARED RULE

The observer belongs to the world

The player begins dispersed. Looking at the reflected self gathers the body; the mirror makes an existing rule accessible. Attention is both a way to care for a place and a condition for moving through it.

ATTENTION HAS A DURATION

Form holds, then gives way

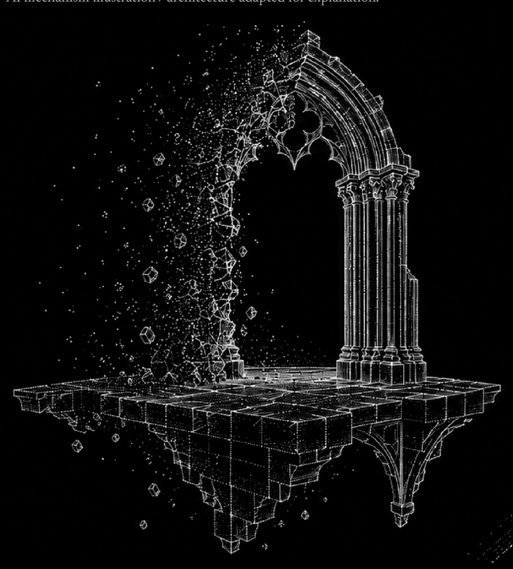
Visibility, distance and sustained looking matter. After the gaze moves away, a form holds briefly before dispersing. Fixed objects begin protected, but that protection is gradually lost.

AT AN ECLIPSE

Gathered: retained Dispersed: erased

Erasure lasts for this round. Ordinary gaze cannot recall the original.

AI mechanism illustration / architecture adapted for explanation.



01 / LOOK

Attention becomes form

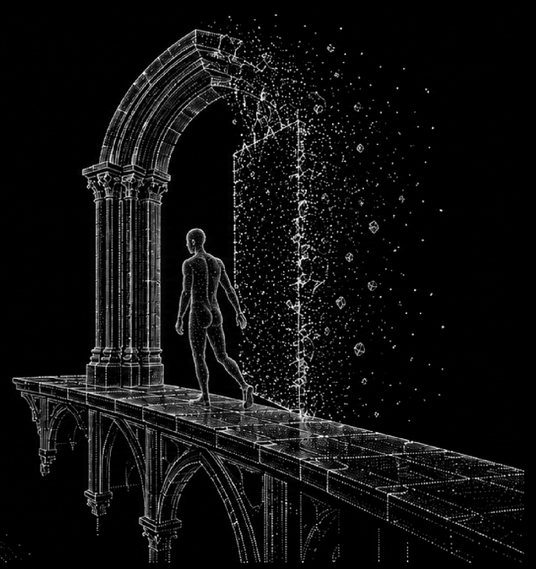
Sustained gaze gathers particles into an object. Dispersed forms are still present and can be gathered again. Familiarity can grow before their contours become complete.



02 / RECOGNIZE

The self also gathers

A gathered player can cross a dispersed obstacle; the other state combinations block passage. Self-observation therefore changes what the same space allows.



03 / LOOK AWAY

Let a passage remain open

Looking at a door would gather it. Turn away, wait, then walk backward while still gathered. Sometimes keeping a route usable means allowing something to disperse.

Conceptual rule relationships / Move: WASD · Look: Mouse · Jump: Space. No unrecorded gaze duration is implied by this illustration.

Engineering a fragile world.

How much can an image lose and still be a place?

LEARNING, THEN CHANGING APPROACH

From a sphere to spatial form

Technical ideas learned from *Return of the Obra Dinn* led to a sphere around the player: particles on its surface, tone representing distance. Rendering demands fell, but space felt less convincing.

THE EXPERIMENT AS A DESIGN TOOL

Compare the behavior

Browser studies compared color, tone, density, speed and movement. Depth and staggered lifetimes helped changing forms remain readable during navigation.

APPEARANCE IS A PLAYABLE CONDITION

Object state connects particles, collision and eclipse outcomes. The image explains a possible action.



01 / mesh topology 02 / selected edges 03 / sampled points

ORIGINAL MESH

Read the construction

Surface triangulation introduces edges that do not all help a player recognize openings and supports.

SELECTED EDGES

Keep what describes form

Merge nearby vertices. Compare adjacent face normals. Keep meaningful boundaries and changes in direction; let coplanar subdivisions recede.

PARTICLE CONTOURS

Make structure temporary

Sample particles along selected edges. Individual points, controlled gaps and motion preserve a readable silhouette without turning the building into an opaque surface.

AI bridge study / Bottom-left: actual Blender reconstruction. Clear windows reveal the bridge: model → structure → sampled particles.

A map made of understanding.

Each place teaches a relationship. A return changes how and when it can be used.

Follow the annotations to discover each place's role.

01 LANDMARKS & SOUND

Give memory a place

Bridges, towers and churches make the route recognizable. Piano music establishes a remembered place; weakening stopwatch ticks give way to silence before an eclipse.

02 THE STAIRCASE / AFTER AN ECLIPSE

An absence opens a route

First, gather the stairs and climb. On a later return, their erasure opens the route below. Two discoveries explain both why to arrive earlier and how to begin earlier.

03 THE MAIN BRIDGE / THREE CONDITIONS

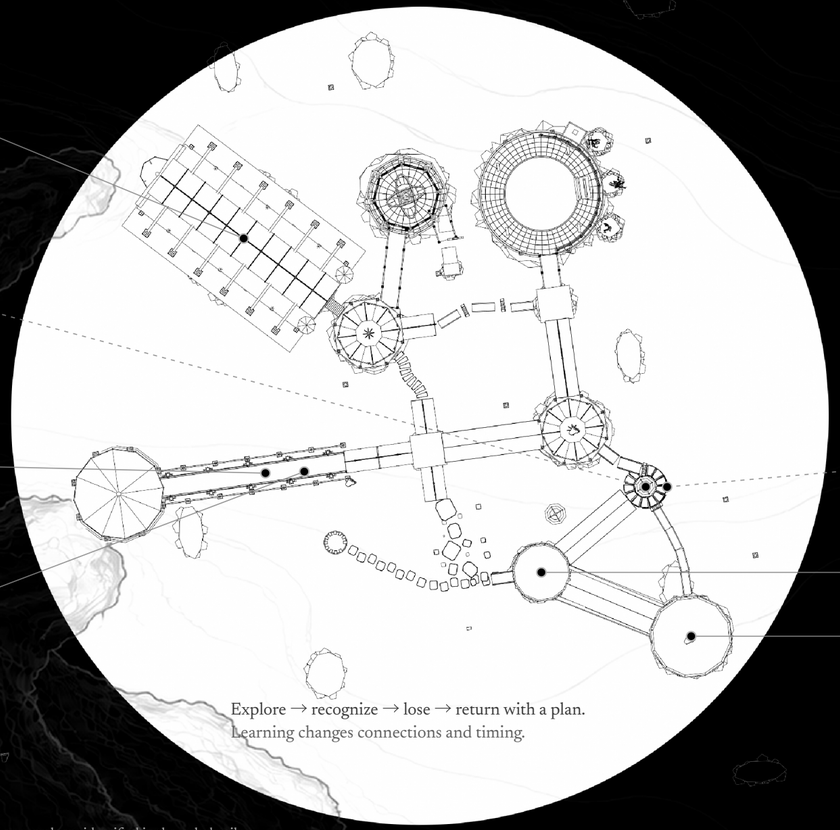
Keep the bridge. Let the gate go.

Reach the viewpoint early. Keep the bridge gathered, allow the entrance gate to disperse, and keep yourself gathered. At the eclipse: bridge remains, gate is erased, player survives.

04 FACING MIRRORS / ON THE RETAINED BRIDGE

Let reflection extend the road

Looking at reflected objects can form corresponding entities. One pair of facing mirrors repeats that relationship to extend the retained bridge into a long walkable road.



Explore → recognize → lose → return with a plan.
Learning changes connections and timing.

05 STARTING ROOM / CEILING MIRROR

Begin with the mirror

A later view reveals the mirror above the starting room. In a new round, gather yourself here and pass through the still-dispersed staircase before the first eclipse.

06 MIRROR-HALL SEQUENCE / TEACHING DETAIL

Experience, then choose

The corridor mirror draws the gaze toward the self. Gathering the body allows a fall through the dispersed floor. The next door asks for deliberate use: look away and step backward.

07 A RETURN WITH UNDERSTANDING

Two branches, one plan

The viewpoint shows a bridge already lost: why arrive earlier. The route above the start reveals self-gathering at the beginning: how. These discoveries change the next attempt's timing.

08 AFTER THE FINAL DISAPPEARANCE

One last look at the moon

Gaze no longer restores the path. Steps make nearby space reappear; missteps return the player to their previous standing point. Familiarity guides the final ascent. The whole world does not return.

Spatial model with repainted terrain / Leaders indicate model regions and related learning stages. Exact object positions may differ; optional proposals are identified in the web details.

A familiar place. A different possibility.

Three encounters with one staircase make knowledge visible in the route.

KNOWLEDGE REPLACES AN UPGRADE

The rules stay. The understanding changes.

The second and third encounters depend on different conditions. Erasure leaves an empty place. State-based passage crosses an object still present. Understanding changes the route without upgrading the body.

A DETAIL THAT CHANGES THE BEGINNING

A chandelier's top and the reflected self reveal the ceiling mirror from above. It can be stood on.

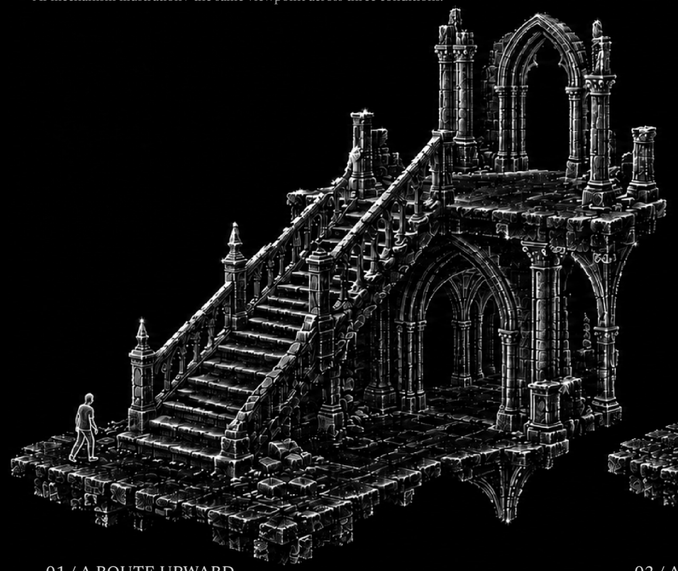


FROM A CONSEQUENCE TO DELIBERATE ACTION

Mirror → body → floor → backward door.

The corridor first makes the rule tangible. The next obstacle asks the player to manage it deliberately.

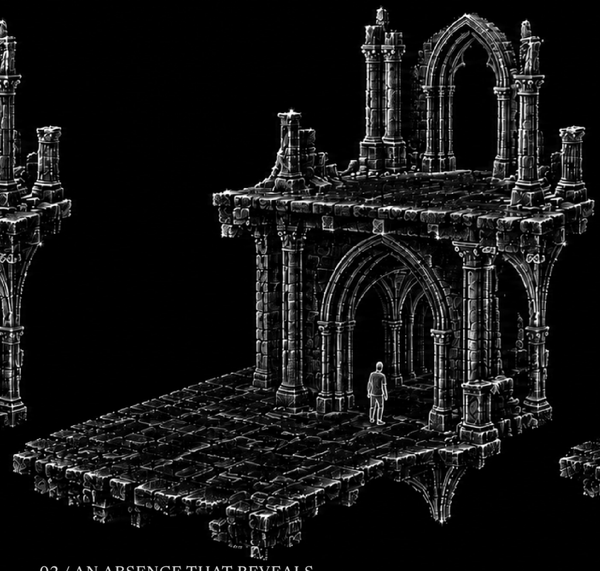
AI mechanism illustration / the same viewpoint across three conditions.



01 / A ROUTE UPWARD

Look. Gather. Climb.

Gathering makes the staircase usable. Climbing establishes its silhouette and position, and the expectation that this place leads upward.

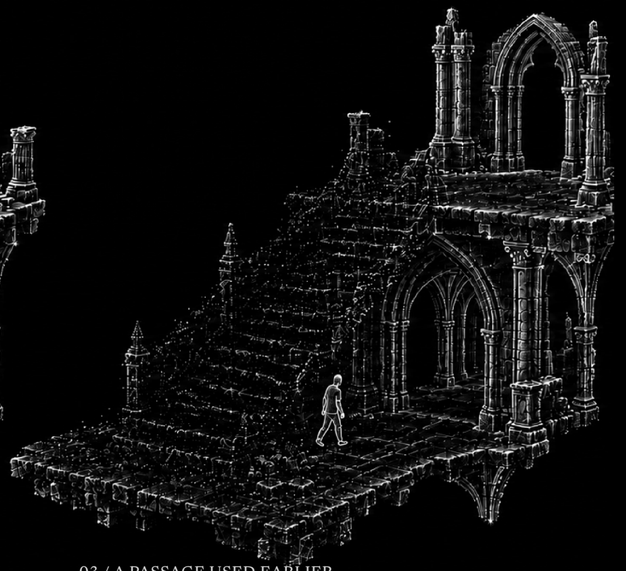


02 / AN ABSENCE THAT REVEALS

What was beneath it?

After an eclipse erases the staircase, its absence reveals a passage. Revisiting a familiar structure turns what is missing into a new route.

Why earlier? The viewpoint shows a bridge already lost.



03 / A PASSAGE USED EARLIER

Gather the self instead.

In a later attempt, gather the body at the start. Cross the still-dispersed stairs before the eclipse and reach the bridge early.

How earlier? The starting mirror made it possible all along.

AI-generated architectural forms adapted for explanation / The ceiling mirror is standable. Falling through the floor belongs to the corridor sequence.

Learning from players.

Make the rules legible. Keep the quiet.

41,833
Bilibili video views
Recorded 24 September 2026

01 / GAME JAM

Make the cause understandable

Players noticed objects gathering without connecting the change to their gaze. Some began jumping before the route was clear.

I shortened gaze duration and added a narrow teaching bridge that must be gathered before crossing, bringing the cause and consequence into one situation.

Looking → forming → crossing.

02 / PUBLIC RELEASE

Continue through play and discussion

The Bilibili release and browser-playable link brought further feedback. I reduced platforming difficulty, refined gaze timing, made hints more direct and continued revising the visuals.

After revision, I observed more positive responses in many later comments.

That is an author observation, not a measured satisfaction rate. Video reach does not describe the number of players.

VOICES / IN THE SAME SPACE 12 FRAGMENTS · 20 ARCHIVED COMMENTS



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PARALLEL PLANES / SHARED DEPTH

Real archived public comments / July 2026. Original Chinese excerpts retained; click a plane for the full thread. Static portfolio preserves the shared depth without motion.